

This project turns raw Medicare claims and enrollment files into spouse-level event-time panels around one spouse's first heart attack or stroke, then reuses those constructed files for the main event studies, heterogeneity analyses, appendix robustness checks, annual spending tables, and a separate day-21 SNF cost-sharing RD. Format below is script — purpose — key inputs — key outputs — main links; abbreviations are IE=indexevents.dta, IB=indexevents_base.dta, IMS=indexevents_mergedspouses_eligible.dta, WP=weekpanel.dta, REM=responseevents-MEDPAR.dta, REMDS=responseevents-MDS.dta, Mort=mortality.dta, and RD=RDdata.dta.

Driver and core construction

ValueHealthySpouse_Master.do — master runner — configured globals — paper tables/figures — calls 1–11 + appendix
Inflation.do — in-memory deflator — spending var, year — adjusted values — used by 3a, 10
1_IdentifyIndexEvents.do — first index MI/stroke stays + discharge traits — raw MEDPAR, BSF deaths — IE — feeds 3 and panel rebuilds
2_ResponseEvents_MEDPAR.do — spouse hospital/SNF response events — raw MEDPAR — REM — feeds 3, 4a, 11, appendix rebuilds
2_ResponseEvents_MDS.do — stay-level SNF spells from MDS V2/V3 — raw MDS — REMDS, MDS-stays.dta, 1% backups — feeds MDS branch
2a_ResponseEvents_ED.do — monthly ED counts — 20% IP/OP claims — EDdx.dta — optional merge in 4 and 5
2b_ResponseEvents_mortality.do — bene death-date lookup — BSF deaths — Mort — balanced-sample filters, 8
2c_ResponseEvents_Falls.do — monthly fall indicators — inpatient diagnoses — responseevents-falls.dta — optional merge in 4 and 5
3_ConstructPanel.do — spouse matching + weekly eligible panel — IE, REM, spouse links, BSF eligibility — IB, IMS, WP — common upstream object
3a_SummaryStatsTable.do — Table 1 covariates in sample — WP, BSF, BSFCC, BSFCU — sumstats-new.tex — descriptive table

Main event studies and tables

4_MainEventStudy_MEDPAR.do — main monthly spouse SNF-use ES — WP + optional Mort/falls/ED/LASSO merges — main graphs — Figure 1 branch
4_MainEventStudy_MDS.do — MDS occupancy/entry ES — external main_eventsstudy.dta, MDS-stays.dta — MDS graphs — MDS analogue of 4
4a_MainEventStudy_snf-entry.do — recode SNF use to entry/exit — WP, REM — entry/exit regdata, graphs — appendix companion to 4
5_HealthEffectsTable_MEDPAR.do — month-0 pooled/fatal/nonfatal health effects — WP + optional Mort/falls/ED — health-effects staging dta — feeds 5a
5b_HealthEffectsTable_AverageEffects_MEDPAR.do — average post-period health effects — same inputs as 5 — appended staging rows — companion to 5a
5a_MakeTable_MEDPAR.do — format Table 2 — health-effects staging dta — health_effects_pooled.tex — final table writer
6_MainEventStudy_FatalitySplit_MEDPAR.do — split ES by fatal vs nonfatal shocks — WP, Mort — subgroup graphs — Figure 3
6_MainEventStudy_FatalitySplit_MDS.do — MDS analogue of 6 — weekly panel as written — MDS subgroup graphs — MDS Figure 3 branch
7a_SplitEffects_ChronicCondition_MEDPAR.do — split by spouse chronic burden — WP, BSFCC, optional Mort — subgroup figures — Figure 4
7a_SplitEffects_ChronicCondition_MDS.do — MDS analogue of 7a — weekly panel, BSFCC — MDS subgroup figures — MDS heterogeneity
7b_SplitEffects_IndexDischarge_MEDPAR.do — split by index home vs facility discharge — WP, optional Mort — subgroup figures — Figure 5
7b_SplitEffects_IndexDischarge_MDS.do — MDS analogue of 7b — weekly panel — MDS subgroup figures — MDS heterogeneity
8_MortalityEffects.do — response-spouse mortality ES by index fatality — WP, Mort — mortality graphs — Figure 6

Prediction, spending, and cost sharing

9_LASSO_predict_snf.do — predicted discharge-to-SNF model — raw MEDPAR, BSF enrollment — LASSO training/prediction files, histogram — feeds 9_merge, 9_LASSO
9_merge_LASSOdata.do — align predicted SNF probabilities to event time — WP, lasso_prob_snf_3folds.dta — tomerge_probsnf.dta — feeds 9_LASSO and optional 4
9_LASSOTable.do — compare actual vs predicted spillovers — WP, Mort, tomerge_probsnf.dta — decomposition regdata, graphs — predicted-SNF results
10_AnnualSpending.do — annualize exposure and spending — WP, BSFCU spending, Inflation.do — yearpanel.dta, Table 4 tex — spending results
11_CostSharingRD.do — day-21 SNF RD sample + estimates — REM, IMS — RD, RD plots, D-DiscTable.tex — Figure 7, Table 5
11a_CostSharingRD_ChronicCondition.do — split RD by spouse chronic burden — RD, BSFCC — D-DiscTable.byChronicCondition.tex — appendix RD heterogeneity
11b_CostSharingRD_EventsStudy.do — attach LOS/coverage expiration to ES — WP, Mort, affected_SNFstays.dta — LOS/coverage graphs — bridge from RD to ES

Appendix event-study variants

Appendix/Appendix_Validata_Specification_MEDPAR.do — extra baseline periods + individual FE sensitivity — WP, Mort — validatamodel.*.dta, comparison graph — robustness branch of 4
Appendix/Appendix_Circularity.do — placebo heart/stroke ES — WP, Mort — circularity figure — falsification around 4
Appendix/Appendix_ExtraHouseholdEvents_EventStudy_MEDPAR.do — allow multiple household events — indexevents_mergespouses.dta, REM, Mort — weekpanel_me.dta, figure — alternative panel builder
Appendix/Appendix_Robustness_No2YearRequirement_MEDPAR.do — drop 2-year no-prior-event rule — IE, REM, Mort — weekpanel_no2y.dta, figure — alternative panel builder
Appendix/Appendix_MainEventStudy_gendersplit_MEDPAR.do — split ES by couple gender direction — WP, Mort — gender-split figure — heterogeneity version of 4
Appendix/Appendix_EventStudy_weeks_MEDPAR.do — weekly-frequency ES — WP, Mort — weekly dynamic figure — timing check for 4
Appendix/Appendix_Eventsstudy_agesplits_MEDPAR.do — split by index age, response age, age gap — chars_weekpanel.dta, Mort — age-split figures — heterogeneity branch
Appendix/Appendix_LongrunResults_MEDPAR.do — four-year gap + quarterly horizons — IB, REM, Mort — ax.*.panels, long-run figure — longer-horizon rebuild
Appendix/Appendix_LocationPreferences_MEDPAR.do — same-SNF/different-SNF/no-SNF margins — WP, Mort — location-preference figure — decomposition of 4
Appendix/Appendix_SplitEffects_Race_MEDPAR.do — split by response race — WP, Mort, BSF race — race figure — heterogeneity branch
Appendix/Appendix_SplitEffects_IndexLOS_MEDPAR.do — split by index-stay LOS — WP, Mort — LOS figure — heterogeneity branch
Appendix/Appendix_SplitEffects_IndexLOS_MDS.do — MDS analogue of LOS split — weekly panel as written — MDS LOS figure — MDS heterogeneity
Appendix/Appendix_SplitEffect_TimeofDeath_MEDPAR.do — refine fatal-shock timing by death month/quarter — WP, Mort — time-of-death figures — refinement of 6 and 8

Appendix RD tables

Appendix/Appendix_DDiscSplit_EventType.do — RD heterogeneity by event type — RD — subgroup globals, p-value sketch — intended appendix companion to 11
Appendix/Appendix_DDiscSplit_Gender.do — RD heterogeneity by focal-spouse gender — RD — D-DiscTable_byGender.tex — appendix companion to 11
Appendix/Appendix_DDiscSplit_ADRD.do — RD heterogeneity by response-spouse ADRD — ADRDdx.dta, RD — D-DiscTable_byADRD.tex — appendix companion to 11
Appendix/Appendix_DDiscSplit_QuarterofYear.do — RD heterogeneity by months since shock — RDdata_fullyear.dta — D-DiscTable_fullyear.tex — appendix companion to 11

Scripts 1–3 create the reusable event-date, response-event, and spouse-week analysis files that everything

else builds on. The main paper then branches from WP into baseline event studies, health and spending

tables, and a prediction extension, while Script 11 creates the separate RD sample that feeds the

cost-sharing tables and appendix splits. Appendix scripts mostly rerun the same design under alternative

sample rules, horizons, or subgroup definitions rather than constructing new raw-data pipelines.